

15 minutes of continuous shooting, handling comfort will stick out like a sore thumb. A camcorder that doesn't sit comfortably in your grip can be annoying, and can cause you to lose focus on the thing that your supposed to be doing: shoot good-quality video. Be sure to test this out before making your purchase. The camcorder should sit comfortably in your hand (or on your shoulder), and you shouldn't need to engage in acrobatics to activate a function or access a button!

1.2 The Specs Explained — What to look for

As with all consumer products, some features are there more for the marketing buzz, with little practical utility, while certain features will make or break your camcorder experience. Before deciding on your camcorder, be sure to review the specs against this guide. Where possible, test out the features and functionality and satisfy yourself with the performance you get.

1.2.1. CCD (Charge Coupled Device)

The Charge Coupled Device or CCD chip as it is called is the heart of the digital video camera.

The CCD “reads” the visible light that falls on it and converts it into a digital electronic signal which is then stored on the tape, DVD, or other storage device as available on the camcorder. Usually,

